

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting - August 17th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zpKJc5KbPVc
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Delaware County Commissioners Regular Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 17, 2026

Location: Delaware County, Indiana

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Presiding Officer:** The meeting was called to order at **00:09:08** by the presiding officer (Board President Riggins). The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Ryan, Commissioner Graham, Commissioner Riggins (President).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:**

- Motion to remove and approve meeting minutes from July 6, 2026 (as amended).
 - Motion to remove and approve meeting minutes from July 20, 2026 (as amended).
 - Motion to table approval of the August 3, 2026 meeting minutes.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:09:56 Emergency Management Flood Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Corey Kissick, Emergency Management Director; Kyle Johnson, Chief Information Officer; Congresswoman Victoria Sparks; Director Cummings.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Director Kissick reported on an unprecedented county-wide flooding disaster resulting from over 10 inches of rain across Muncie, Yorktown, Dale, and Daleville. Over 400 evacuations, rescues, and welfare checks were conducted by first responders. Tragically, two confirmed fatalities were reported.
 - The Emergency Operations Center (EOC) transitioned from response to recovery at level 3 enhanced monitoring. Over 400 damage report surveys have been received, with field assessments of 500–1,000 structures starting the next day. Local disaster declarations were issued alongside state and federal declarations.
 - CIO Kyle Johnson highlighted county website resources (delawarecounty.in.gov) for damage reporting and recovery resource mapping.
 - Congresswoman Victoria Sparks provided federal updates, noting the presidential emergency declaration approval and ongoing coordination for a major disaster declaration to unlock individual assistance (FEMA funds). She expressed disappointment regarding Red Cross engagement and offered assistance connecting with neighboring county resources.
 - Director Cummings updated the board on the catastrophic failure of the Samson communication tower due to flooding, resulting in destroyed infrastructure, temporary loss of VHF paging/sirens, and fallback reliance on the 800 MHz and Delta tower sites. A preliminary repair estimate stands at approximately \$2.5 million. The board authorized a \$45,000 expense for immediate VHF temporary restoration.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Information presented; no formal board action required.
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00:18:57 Highway Department Flood & Damage Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tommy Humbert, Delaware County Highway Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Humbert reported extensive road closures and severe damage to road edges and culverts. Crews exhausted all available barricades and acquired unlabelled

ones due to shortages. 400 South between Proctor Road and 400 West will remain closed indefinitely pending utility locates and culvert replacement design.

- **Action & Disposition:** Information presented; received.
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00:44:31 Public Hearing: Ordinance 2026-13 (Traffic Regulation Amendment)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County engineering staff / Dean.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Public hearing for an ordinance amending traffic regulations on certain public streets, specifically establishing a four-way stop at Walnut Street South (Old 3 South) and Fuson Road. Traffic data showed 26 accidents within the last five years, satisfying warrants for a multi-way stop. No public comments were made during the hearing.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Motion to close the public hearing passed unanimously by roll call vote. (Later approved as Ordinance 2026-13 under subsequent business).
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Board Appointments

- **00:46:50 Board of Health Appointments:**
 - The Board of Health submitted two Republican medical doctor nominees to replace Dr. Dowell: Dr. Jeffrey Albrecht (urologist) and Dr. Hal Dixon (neurologist).
 - *Action & Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote to appoint **Dr. Jeffrey Albrecht** to the Board of Health.
 - Note: Discussion regarding an open Democratic board seat noted that the board is awaiting nominations from the Mayor of Muncie.
 - **00:49:56 Fair Board Appointment:**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Board members.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Reviewed a letter of interest from Andrew Balsam, a 10-year 4-H member.
 - *Action & Disposition:* **Approved by roll call vote** to appoint Andrew Balsam to the Fair Board.
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Tabled & Old Business Items

- **00:52:32 Soil and Water Conservation Funding Request:** Tabled after discussion regarding budget lines and availability of funds (\$21,000 currently budgeted in account 380/390).
- **00:57:34 Presentation: Tobacco-Free Coalition Amendment:** Jordan Moss (Little Red Door Cancer Agency & Tobacco Free Coalition) presented a policy clarification adding Electronic Nicotine Delivery Systems (ENDS) to local tobacco policies. Board members

expressed hesitation regarding expanded definitions (such as cannabis/marijuana inclusion). *Disposition*: No motion made; request died.

- **07:07:03 Priest Ford Bridge Project Proposal**: Brandon Cook presented a five-phase plan to acquire, secure, and restore the historic camelback truss bridge. Board members noted that the county does not own all surrounding land or portions of the bridge structure itself. *Disposition*: Tabled to allow the applicant to consult property records at the Auditor's office.
 - **01:13:54 On-Call Mowing Service Bids**:
 - *Presenter*: Dean / Commissioners.
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Reviewed bids from Bailey's Landscape, All Seasons Landscape, and Smith Family Services for on-call property maintenance and weed abatement. Smith Family Services submitted the lowest overall pricing across the majority of items.
 - *Action & Disposition*: **Approved by roll call vote** to award the on-call mowing contract to **Smith Family Services**.
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Facility Maintenance, IT, and Engineering Approvals

- **01:16:50 Maintenance Department - Floor Scrubbers**: Don Chambers presented quotes for floor scrubbers. *Action & Disposition*: Approved the purchase of a 20-inch powered walk-behind scrubber (Power Flight model) for **\$4,999** funded out of Edit 12 / capital projects.
 - **01:42:31 Maintenance Department - Jail Alarm System Troubleshooting**: *Action & Disposition*: **Approved by roll call vote** (Edit 12) for a \$1,654.95 quote from Corson to troubleshoot ground fault alarms prior to security monitoring installation.
 - **01:59:02 IT Department - Microsoft 365 Funding**: Ryan Stoltz requested funding to transition county email/software to Microsoft 365. *Action & Disposition*: **Approved by roll call vote** for a "not to exceed" amount of **\$235,000** from Edit 10 (IT infrastructure) for 2027, with subsequent costs shifting to individual departmental budgets in 2028.
 - **01:28:45 Highway Department - Bridge No. 5 Hydraulic Study**: *Action & Disposition*: **Approved by roll call vote** for a **\$42,971** engineering and hydraulic study proposal with GAI Consultants (subcontracted with Apex) for Bridge No. 5 (Timber Slough North over Finley Manor Ditch) utilizing Cumulative Bridge funds.
 - **01:31:48 Human Resources - Handbook Amendments**: *Action & Disposition*: Approved handbook amendments regarding final paycheck insurance premium deductions (Sections 2.23.7 & 2.23.8.5) and 195-hour PTO bank clarifications (Section 6.10.3.1).
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Ordinances & Resolutions

- **01:34:04 Ordinance 2026-11 (Adjustment of Pay Periods for 2027):** Rejected after feedback from the Auditor's office and department heads indicated severe administrative and overtime tracking burdens associated with moving to 24 pay periods. *Disposition:* **Failed / Rejected by roll call vote.**
 - **01:36:47 Ordinance 2026-12 (Roadway Use Permits):** Amended to remove mailbox provisions and focus strictly on roadway cuts and right-of-way work permits. *Disposition:* **Adopted by roll call vote.**
 - **01:37:58 Ordinance 2026-13 (Traffic Regulations - Walnut & Fuson Four-Way Stop):** *Disposition:* **Adopted by roll call vote.**
 - **01:38:37 Ordinance 2026-14 (Vacation of Hatley Plat / Second Street):** *Disposition:* **Adopted by roll call vote.**
 - **01:39:20 Ordinance 2026-15:** Tabled upon request of Building Commissioner Tom Paultz for further health department integration.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:05:09 Yancey (Resident, Muncie):** Inquired regarding residency requirements for the Mayor's Board of Health appointments. Clarified that appointees may be county residents.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Board & Staff Announcements:**
 - **ADA Training:** Reminded employees to review online ADA slide decks.
 - **LIT Meeting:** Announced a Municipal Unified Strategic Task Force meeting scheduled for August 18 at 4:00 PM in the commissioners' room.
 - **Flood Warning:** Commissioners warned residents to watch out for fraudulent storm repair contractors and scammers following the disaster.
 - **Veteran Services:** Brian Wilson and Nate Jones announced the upcoming annual Veterans Stand Down event on September 15, 10:00 AM – 2:00 PM at the Delaware County Fairgrounds (Heartland Hall), seeking local manufacturing employers as vendors.
 - **Sheriff Tony Skinner:** Publicly commended deputies, correctional staff, and first responders for extraordinary heroism and tireless work amid a consecutive week of critical incidents (river stabbing, 9-hour SWAT standoff, and severe flooding).
- **Claims & Financial Approvals:**
 - General Claims: **\$4,921,279.13** (Approved by roll call vote).
 - Credit Card Claims: **\$13,967.63** (Approved by roll call vote; Commissioner Brand voted No).
 - ARP Claims: **\$6,500.00** (Approved by roll call vote).
 - Payroll (August 12): **\$1,052,356.05** (Approved by roll call vote).

- **Adjournment:** Following a moment of silence for residents who lost their lives in the county flooding disaster, a motion to recess/adjourn was made and seconded. Meeting adjourned.

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